

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody consists of quarter and half notes, with some phrases spanning across bar lines. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: E-flat, Fm, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, B-flat/sus, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, Fm, G, E-flat/G, Gm, Fm, B-flat, and E-flat. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each corresponding to a line of the melody. The first system has three lines of lyrics, the second has three, and the third has three. The lyrics are: 1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now, 2 Now of my three - score years and ten, 3 And since to look at things in bloom hung with bloom a - long the bough, twen - ty will not come a - gain. fif - ty springs are lit - tle room, it stands a - bout the wood - land ride And take from sev'n - ty springs a score, a - bout the wood - lands I will go, wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide. leav - ing me just fif - ty more. see the cher - ry hung with snow.

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2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom
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And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
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